

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 59)

Page 292 - James Bridie and Noel Coward

Q1. James Bridie chose his themes from a more varied field than Bernard Shaw and was more restlessly:

- A. Political
- B. Experimental
- C. Sentimental
- D. Religious

Answer: B

Q2. Bridie wrote only three plays which are good throughout, including:

- A. The Apple Cart
- B. The Anatomist, Tobias and the Angel, and Mr. Bolfry
- C. Saint Joan and Village Wooing
- D. Quadrille and Hay Fever

Answer: B

Q3. Bridie's play 'Mr. Bolfry' administers a dose of:

- A. Irish mythology
- B. Scottish metaphysics
- C. Welsh folklore
- D. English history

Answer: B

Q4. Only fragments of genius can be extracted from which of Bridie's plays?

- A. A Sleeping Clergyman and Daphne Laureola
- B. The Anatomist and Tobias and the Angel
- C. Mr. Bolfry
- D. Saint Joan

Answer: A

Q5. The darkening political scene in 1928 led James Bridie to write:

- A. The Forrigan Reel
- B. King of Nowhere

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C. A Sleeping Clergyman

D. Mr. Bolfry

Answer: B

Q6. In 1944, Bridie wrote a wildly contrasting play with bewildering abandon titled:

A. Daphne Laureola

B. The Forrigan Reel

C. Tobias and the Angel

D. The Anatomist

Answer: B

Q7. According to the text, a play that fails on the stage yet is good to read suggests the author should have written a:

A. Longer play

B. Poem

C. Novel, pamphlet, or some other reading matter

D. Film script

Answer: C

Q8. The text asserts that theatres are temples of:

A. Worship

B. Education

C. Illusion and make-believe

D. Political debate

Answer: C

Q9. If a playwright can create for the audience an illusion of reality, he will succeed in the theatre even though he may not produce anything that is:

A. Entertaining

B. Important as literature

C. Financially successful

D. Popular with actors

Answer: B

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Q10. Noel Coward made his mark just after the first World War with a tense and emotionally strained play titled:

- A. Hay Fever
- B. The Vortex
- C. This Happy Breed
- D. Quadrille

Answer: B

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Page 293 - Noel Coward, Terence Rattigan, and J.B. Priestley

Q1. Noel Coward wrote brittle comedies about trivial leisured people, characterized by:

- A. Deep philosophical themes
- B. The clipped style and conventionally unconventional behavior then fashionable
- C. Somber and tragic tones
- D. Lengthy poetic monologues

Answer: B

Q2. With which comedy did Noel Coward move up a step in the literary scale, comparable to Oscar Wilde's work?

- A. The Vortex
- B. This Happy Breed
- C. Quadrille
- D. Hay Fever

Answer: D

Q3. As Noel Coward grew older, he grew more serious without growing duller, as seen in:

- A. The Vortex
- B. Hay Fever
- C. This Happy Breed
- D. Quadrille

Answer: C

Q4. Which play by Noel Coward provided two great players with excellent parts, particularly in a witty scene in Act III?

- A. Quadrille
- B. This Happy Breed
- C. The Winslow Boy
- D. Time and the Conways

Answer: A

Q5. Terence Rattigan's 'The Winslow Boy' is based on an actual case involving a:

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- A. Politician accused of bribery
- B. Naval cadet falsely accused and punished for theft
- C. Soldier fleeing the battlefield
- D. Doctor accused of murder

Answer: B

Q6. J.B. Priestley turned to playwriting after his great success as a novelist with:

- A. The Good Companions
- B. Time and the Conways
- C. I Have Been Here Before
- D. Johnson Over Jordan

Answer: A

Q7. Priestley made his most original contributions to the theatre with plays dealing with the new theories of:

- A. Gravity
- B. Relativity
- C. Time evolved by certain philosophers
- D. Biological evolution

Answer: C

Q8. Which of Priestley's plays touches upon the theory that time consists of a continuous present?

- A. The Good Companions
- B. Time and the Conways and I Have Been Here Before
- C. The Winslow Boy
- D. The Vortex

Answer: B

Q9. In which play did Priestley attempt to explore deeper themes, leading him to scold the public for its inattentiveness?

- A. Johnson Over Jordan
- B. Time and the Conways
- C. The Good Companions
- D. Quadrille

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Answer: A

Q10. The text suggests that the failure of Priestley's deeper attempts was mainly due to:

- A. The audience's lack of intelligence
- B. His omission to recognize that good intentions do not counterbalance lapses from sound stage craftsmanship
- C. The actors' poor performances
- D. Interference from censors

Answer: B

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Page 294 - Statesmen-Authors and Historians

Q1. Laurence Housman wrote 'Happy and Glorious', a series of episodes in the life of:

- A. St. Francis
- B. Queen Victoria
- C. Lord Marlborough
- D. William the Silent

Answer: B

Q2. Benjamin Disraeli wrote a good many novels in the nineteenth century, including:

- A. Only political pamphlets
- B. Some fantastic and flippantly witty, others serious political studies
- C. Solely children's fairy tales
- D. Only historical romances

Answer: B

Q3. Arthur James Balfour was the author of philosophical works such as:

- A. On England
- B. A Defence of Philosophic Doubt
- C. My Early Life
- D. The Servile State

Answer: B

Q4. Which author's lifetime of experience as a soldier, statesman, and writer coincided with the most troubled period of modern world history?

- A. Benjamin Disraeli
- B. Stanley Baldwin
- C. Winston Churchill
- D. Arthur James Balfour

Answer: C

Q5. In 'My Early Life', Winston Churchill tells the story of his capture and escape during:

- A. The first World War

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- B. The second World War
- C. The South African war of 1899-1902
- D. The Crimean War

Answer: C

Q6. Winston Churchill brought renown to himself as a biographer with the Life of Lord Randolph Churchill and the Life of:

- A. Queen Victoria
- B. Marlborough
- C. Garibaldi
- D. William the Silent

Answer: B

Q7. Churchill obtained chief eminence as a writer with his histories of:

- A. The British Empire
- B. The two World Wars
- C. The English Civil War
- D. The French Revolution

Answer: B

Q8. Churchill's literary style is described as:

- A. Cold and objective
- B. Vigorous and glowing, befitting his subjects
- C. Dull and pedantic
- D. Overly romantic

Answer: B

Q9. G.M. Trevelyan established his reputation with a three-part work on which figure's campaign for an independent Italy?

- A. Mussolini
- B. Garibaldi
- C. Cavour
- D. Mazzini

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Answer: B

Q10. Trevelyan's 'English Social History: A Survey of Six Centuries' made the wartime generation of the 1940s eager to read:

- A. Poetry
- B. Fiction
- C. History
- D. Drama

Answer: C

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Page 295 - Biography, Philosophy, and Travel

Q1. C.V. Wedgwood's excellent biography 'William the Silent' was followed by a larger history of the:

- A. English Civil War
- B. French Revolution
- C. Hundred Years' War
- D. Wars of the Roses

Answer: A

Q2. The first volume of C.V. Wedgwood's history of the English Civil War, published in 1955, is titled:

- A. The World Crisis
- B. The King's Peace, 1637-1641
- C. The Stricken Deer
- D. The Young Melbourne

Answer: B

Q3. Lord David Cecil wrote a life of the poet William Cowper titled:

- A. The Young Melbourne
- B. Lord M
- C. The Stricken Deer
- D. Talleyrand

Answer: C

Q4. Duff Cooper (Viscount Norwich) wrote a biography of:

- A. King George V
- B. Talleyrand
- C. Lord Melbourne
- D. William the Silent

Answer: B

Q5. Who made philosophy inexhaustibly fascinating in a number of volumes addressed to general readers?

- A. T.E. Lawrence
- B. Bertrand Russell

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- C. G.M. Trevelyan
- D. Norman Douglas

Answer: B

Q6. Bertrand Russell covers an extensive subject in a pleasurable and enlightening style in his book:

- A. History of Western Philosophy
- B. A Defence of Philosophic Doubt
- C. The World Crisis
- D. The Servile State

Answer: A

Q7. Peter Fleming and Freya Stark are outstanding recent authors of:

- A. Detective novels
- B. Travel books
- C. Biographies
- D. Metaphysical poetry

Answer: B

Q8. 'Brazilian Adventure' and 'One's Company' were written by:

- A. Freya Stark
- B. Peter Fleming
- C. Gertrude Bell
- D. Norman Douglas

Answer: B

Q9. Gertrude Bell wrote travel books such as 'The Desert and the Sown' and:

- A. The Southern Gates of Arabia
- B. Amurath to Amurath
- C. Siren Land
- D. Old Calabria

Answer: B

Q10. Norman Douglas's most original work was the unique satirical novel 'South Wind', set in the island of:

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- A. Sicily
- B. Corsica
- C. Capri
- D. Malta

Answer: C

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Page 296 - T.E. Lawrence, Belloc, and Chesterton

Q1. T.E. Lawrence developed remarkable gifts of military leadership when he headed the desert Arabs against:

- A. Germany
- B. Turkey
- C. France
- D. Egypt

Answer: B

Q2. Disillusioned by the Allies' failure in their promises to the Arabs, T.E. Lawrence joined the Air Force under the name:

- A. T.E. Smith
- B. T.E. Shaw
- C. Lawrence of Arabia
- D. John Doe

Answer: B

Q3. How did T.E. Lawrence die?

- A. In a plane crash
- B. In combat in the desert
- C. Accidentally while riding a fast motor-cycle
- D. Of natural causes in Oxford

Answer: C

Q4. In 1926, Lawrence published an expensive privately-circulated account of the desert campaign titled:

- A. Revolt in the Desert
- B. Seven Pillars of Wisdom
- C. Arabia Deserta
- D. The World Crisis

Answer: B

Q5. T.E. Lawrence learned the craft of writing through close consultation with:

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- A. Winston Churchill
- B. Bertrand Russell
- C. Bernard Shaw and others
- D. T.S. Eliot

Answer: C

Q6. What makes 'Seven Pillars of Wisdom' impersonal and remote in tone?

- A. Its lack of detail
- B. Lawrence's eclecticism of literary style and desire to treat his own part objectively
- C. Its focus only on geography
- D. Its fictional nature

Answer: B

Q7. A condensed version of 'Seven Pillars of Wisdom', issued in 1927, was titled:

- A. The Desert and the Sown
- B. Revolt in the Desert
- C. The Southern Gates of Arabia
- D. Amurath to Amurath

Answer: B

Q8. Hilaire Belloc and G.K. Chesterton often worked in double harness in antagonism towards what Belloc called:

- A. The Servile State
- B. The Modern Utopia
- C. The Victorian Optimism
- D. The English Monarchy

Answer: A

Q9. 'The Servile State' is defined by Belloc as a state in which the individual weighs little against:

- A. Free market capitalism
- B. Bureaucracy and despotism
- C. Religious institutions
- D. Foreign invaders

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Answer: B

Q10. Because of their character and temperament belonging to a passing age of idealism, Belloc may be regarded as the last of the:

- A. Romantics
- B. Realists
- C. Naturalists
- D. Classicists

Answer: A